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Statement of participation

Biniyam Alemayehu

has completed the free course including any mandatory tests for:

Developing a research question in International Relations

This free 3-hour course explored why research questions matter and what makes a good research question.

Issue date: 8 December 2025

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This statement does not imply the award of credit points nor the conferment of a University Qualification.
This statement confirms that this free course and all mandatory tests were passed by the learner.

Please go to the course on OpenLearn for full details:
https://www.open.edu/openlearn/society-politics-law/developing-research-question-international-relations/content-section-0

COURSE CODE: **D828_1**

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Developing a research question in International Relations

https://www.open.edu/openlearn/society-politics-law/developing-research-question-international-relations/content-section-0

Course summary

Research questions are vital for any academic inquiry, yet writing a good one is not easy. A well-designed question enables you to clearly define and communicate a focused area of research in a way that is manageable within the scope of a research project. Through this course, you will learn how to recognise and produce a good research question.

Learning outcomes

By completing this course, the learner should be able to:

- understand what makes a good research question
- reflect on and apply positivist and interpretivist approaches in international relations
- identify different types of questions and how to use them.

Completed study

The learner has completed the following:

Section 1

Masterclass: research questions in International Relations

Section 2

Positivist and interpretivist approaches

Section 3

Types of research questions

Section 4

Descriptive versus analytical questions

Section 5

Developing a good research question